

Teaching Statement

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Knowledge is dynamic—constantly evolving as new discoveries challenge established beliefs. My teaching philosophy is grounded in this reality: my goal is not to tell students *what* to think, but to help them learn *how* to think. I see myself as a craftsman of intellectual tools—a master carpenter teaching the correct use of a hammer, not prescribing how the chair must be built. Once students learn to use the hammer well, they can build with creativity and confidence.

Teaching Experience and Approach

Across my appointments at the Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS) and as Visiting Assistant Professor at Iowa State University, I have found teaching to be one of the most rewarding aspects of academic life. I have taught a broad range of undergraduate and graduate courses—including *Microeconomic Theory*, *Public Finance*, *Intermediate and Principles of Microeconomics*, *Game Theory*, *Development Economics*, *Behavioral Economics*, and *Economic Policy*. These experiences have equipped me to teach both theory- and policy-oriented courses at multiple levels.

In my graduate *Microeconomic Theory* course at Iowa State, I emphasized bridging rigorous theoretical frameworks with real-world relevance—encouraging students to connect abstract models to policy and empirical contexts. At LUMS, I developed and taught *Advanced Behavioral Economics* and *Public Finance* courses that integrated experimental and field evidence from current research, allowing students to see how behavioral insights shape tax policy, public programs, and firm behavior in developing economies.

Engagement and Adaptation in the Classroom

My teaching style is interactive, adaptive, and grounded in the belief that students learn best when they actively apply concepts. I use a combination of methods—whiteboard problem-solving to foster reasoning, slides for structure, and in-class experiments to make theory tangible. For example, while teaching supply and demand, I often simulate a live market in class where students “buy” and “sell” based on their willingness to pay or accept. This exercise transforms abstract curves into lived experience and helps internalize concepts like surplus and equilibrium.

I complement lectures with activities such as group projects, policy debates, and even film analysis—screening *A Beautiful Mind* before discussing Nash equilibrium. I also integrate current events and research findings to show students that economics is not static but a living discipline, continuously reshaped by data and ideas.

Integrating Technology and AI in Teaching

Recent advances in artificial intelligence have fundamentally changed what is possible in the classroom. I am a strong believer that AI can liberate students from many of the routine, time-consuming tasks that once held them back—data cleaning, preliminary literature searches, boilerplate coding—and redirect their energy toward what matters most: thinking deeply and creatively. When students no longer spend hours on the mundane, they can invest that time in questioning assumptions, exploring unconventional approaches, and generating ideas that

push a field forward. In my courses, I actively integrate AI tools and train students to use them responsibly. I encourage them to leverage AI for brainstorming, drafting, and computation, while requiring them to critically evaluate, refine, and take ownership of the output. Rather than viewing AI as a shortcut, I frame it as a catalyst—one that lowers barriers to entry and opens new avenues for intellectual exploration. This philosophy equips students not only with practical digital literacy but also with the confidence to think beyond existing boundaries, turning AI from a convenience into a genuine engine of progress.

Curricular Innovation and Mentorship

At LUMS, I have incorporated the **CORE** open-access curriculum in introductory economics courses to make foundational concepts more relatable and globally relevant. I have also designed new behavioral and policy-oriented electives that blend theory, data, and field evidence—encouraging students to think like economists confronting real-world policy challenges. Many of my students have gone on to pursue graduate studies or research assistantships, and I take pride in mentoring them through research design, proposal writing, and professional development.

Teaching Philosophy in Practice

My teaching philosophy is guided by three principles: **clarity**, **engagement**, and **application**. I begin with intuition before introducing formality; I strive to make learning participatory rather than passive; and I aim to connect classroom knowledge to societal issues. Whether or not my students pursue economics professionally, I want them to leave my classes equipped to reason from evidence, weigh tradeoffs critically, and engage with policy questions as informed citizens.

Commitment to Students and the Discipline

Teaching, for me, is not merely a professional duty but a vocation. I aspire to create a classroom where curiosity thrives and where students feel empowered to question assumptions—including my own. The teachers who shaped my own intellectual journey combined rigor with empathy; I aim to do the same for my students. Whether a student goes on to graduate school, public service, or a career outside economics, my goal is for them to carry forward sharper analytical skills and a lasting sense of intellectual independence.

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